

Cyril Morlet

Senior Backend Engineer — Distributed Systems · Java & Node.js · ex-Bitfinex

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 12 years building distributed systems in production: chain-integration infrastructure at Bitfinex, a top-tier crypto trading exchange (deposit/withdrawal pipelines across L1/L2s — code where bugs lose customer funds), and live real-time game servers — Java 25 (83K+ lines, 1,300+ unique players, solo-operated) plus a ~600K-line platform with a Rust blockchain indexer serving sub-second, low-latency reads at scale. Java across a decade (2016 protocol libraries !Java 25 production server); Node.js/TypeScript ~10 years. Testing and security discipline enforced by mechanical gates; self-hosted production Kubernetes.

SKILLS

Backend: Java 25, Node.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, Bun, Rust (working), WebSocket, REST APIs, GraphQL, microservices

Distributed Systems: event-driven services, real-time netcode, custom blockchain indexers, low-latency reads (Redis 8 JSON/search), horizontal scaling on Kubernetes

Exchange & Crypto: chain integration at Bitfinex — deposits/withdrawals/listings, reorgs, finality thresholds, fee accounting; Sui, EVM; security-critical money paths

Quality: testing discipline (gold/anchor/unit gates), CodeQL, semgrep, CI/CD, observability (Prometheus, Sentry)

Infrastructure: Kubernetes (self-hosted production), Docker, GitOps, Helm

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Solo Engineer — Independent Products

Oct 2024 – Present · Remote

- Built and operate a live MMORPG server in Java 25 (83K+ lines) serving 1,300+ unique players — solo: real-time gameplay backend, low-latency netcode, database design (FalkorDB graph, Redis), Kubernetes deployment, on-call.
- Lead a team of 3 building AresRPG (~600K lines, 12 workspaces): distributed backend on Bun/Node.js with a custom Rust blockchain indexer serving sub-second queries under production load.
- Engineered an agentic development harness (Claude Code multi-agent + mechanical test gates: gold/anchor/unit, CodeQL, semgrep) enforcing testing and code-quality discipline at scale.

Blockchain Integration Specialist — Bitfinex

Apr 2022 – Oct 2024 · Remote

- Owned end-to-end blockchain integrations for production deposit and withdrawal pipelines at a top-tier crypto exchange (Node.js, TypeScript).
- Integrated multiple L1/L2 chain backends into the exchange — including the Sui listing — and maintained them under production load.
- Owned chain-specific edge cases — reorgs, finality thresholds, fee accounting — where a bug loses customer funds.

Fullstack Developer — Affinidi

Jan 2021 – Apr 2022 · Kyiv, Ukraine (remote)

- Shipped React + Node.js microservices for self-sovereign identity and credential verification — REST APIs, Docker, AWS.
- Delivered across distributed teams spanning EU, Singapore, and India.

CTO & Co-founder — Sidy

Jan 2019 – Jan 2021 · Montpellier, France

- Led a 4-engineer team building a real-estate platform from zero to production; owned architecture, infrastructure, and hiring.

Software Engineer — Freelance & Open-Source

Jan 2015 – Jan 2021 · France (remote)

- Created and maintain 18+ open-source npm libraries (auth, real-time graphs, transport, storage) — github.com/HydreIO.

SELECTED PROJECTS

AresRPG — fully on-chain MMORPG on Sui — 9 Move packages, Rust indexer · aresrpg.world

Hytale MMORPG server — live Java 25 game server, 1,300+ players, solo-built and operated

Hydre.io — 18+ open-source npm libraries · github.com/HydreIO

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Self-taught engineer — shipping production code since 2014; open-source maintainer since 2015.

Languages: French (native), English (fluent)